

A GUIDE FROM MATTHEW 28:20

How to Teach God's Word

Every disciple is eventually called to teach someone else. Here is a simple, honest approach to opening Scripture with others.

"And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age."

MATTHEW 28:20

1. Study Before You Speak

Good teaching begins long before anyone is listening. Read the passage in context — what comes before it, what comes after it, who originally wrote it and to whom. Resist the urge to jump straight to application before you understand what the text actually says.

2. Find the One Main Point

A passage may contain many interesting details, but a clear teaching usually has one central idea everything else supports. Before you teach, be able to state that idea in a single sentence. If you can't, keep studying.

3. Explain, Illustrate, Apply

A simple structure that works almost anywhere

- Explain — what does the text actually say, in plain language?
- Illustrate — what everyday picture or story makes this concrete?
- Apply — what should the listener actually do this week because of it?

4. Teach People, Not Just Content

Know who is in front of you. A room of new believers needs different pacing and vocabulary than a room of longtime Christians. Teaching is not a performance of what you know — it is a gift handed to a specific group of people God has put in front of you.

5. Live It First

Teaching carries far more weight when it comes from someone actively working the truth into their own life, including their own struggles with it. You don't need to have mastered a passage to teach it faithfully — you need to be honestly walking toward it.

6. Point to God, Not Yourself

The goal of teaching Scripture is never to make people impressed with the teacher — it's to help them see God more clearly and respond to Him. Keep pointing attention back to the text and to Jesus, not to your own insight.

A Verse to Anchor This

“All Scripture is breathed out by God and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for training in righteousness.” — 2 Timothy 3:16